

RESONANCE COSMOLOGY

Framework and Parameters

A Foundational Charter for a New Branch of Cosmology

Esad Sadikovic

Independent Researcher | 2026

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ABSTRACT

Modern cosmology, despite its remarkable explanatory successes, remains conceptually incomplete. Physical constants appear as arbitrary numerical coincidences rather than structural necessities. Multiverse proposals exist as vast speculative architectures without predictive classification. No universal substrate has been identified from which the laws and constants of nature naturally arise. This paper proposes Resonance Cosmology as a formal new branch of cosmology, grounded in a single organising principle: universes are not random accidents but structured harmonic resonances within the ether continuum. Ether is redefined here — not as the discredited mechanical medium of pre-relativistic physics, but as the universal reflective substrate from which physical constants emerge as resonance fingerprints and from which universes are organised into classified resonance bands. The framework introduces three primary parameters: resonance drift, the deviation of a universe's constants from the central harmonic of its band; band spacing, the interval between resonance bands in the ether spectrum; and harmonic density, the number of universes per band. Together these parameters generate a predictive classification scheme — the Periodic Table of Universes — analogous in structure to Mendeleev's periodic table of elements. Physical constants are interpreted as eigenvalues of ether harmonics, and the methodology anchors abstract mathematics in established physical analogies from spectroscopy, seismic resonance, and wave mechanics. The framework is falsifiable: gaps in the resonance spectrum predict the existence of universes not yet observed, and variations in measured constants between cosmological epochs constitute testable resonance drift signatures. Situated within a philosophical lineage spanning Plato's theory of Forms, Bohm's implicate order, and Jung's archetypes, Resonance Cosmology bridges physics and philosophy without sacrificing scientific rigour. This paper serves as the foundational charter — the birth document of the discipline — and concludes with a formal declaration establishing Resonance Cosmology as a branch of cosmology open to collaboration, critique, and expansion.

1. Introduction: The Incomplete Foundation

Cosmology stands at a paradox. In the century since Einstein's general relativity reshaped our understanding of space, time, and gravity, the discipline has achieved extraordinary explanatory power. The cosmic microwave background radiation has been mapped with exquisite precision.

The large-scale structure of the universe — its web of filaments and voids — has been charted across billions of light-years. The expansion history of the universe has been reconstructed from Type Ia supernovae. The standard cosmological model, Λ CDM, provides a coherent account of the universe from fractions of a second after the Big Bang to the present day.

And yet the foundation remains incomplete. Cosmology describes how the universe evolved but cannot explain why its laws take the specific form they do. The fine-structure constant $\alpha \approx 1/137$ is measured with exquisite precision but no theory explains why it takes that value rather than any other. The cosmological constant — the energy density of the vacuum driving the accelerating expansion — is observed to be 123 orders of magnitude smaller than quantum field theory predicts [1]. Planck's constant, the gravitational constant, the mass of the electron: each is measured precisely and each appears, within the framework of current theory, as a brute fact rather than a structural necessity. Constants are handed to the theory from outside; they are not generated by it.

The multiverse proposals that emerged from inflationary cosmology [2,3] and string theory's landscape [4] attempted to address this by proposing that the constants of nature vary across a vast ensemble of universes, with our particular values selected anthropically — we observe the values we do because only certain values permit observers to exist. This is a coherent response to the fine-tuning problem, but it purchases explanatory power at an enormous cost: the multiverse, as typically formulated, is an unstructured infinity. It has no classification principle, no predictive taxonomy, no means of organising its posited diversity into a form from which specific predictions about our universe could be derived. A theory that can explain anything explains nothing.

This paper proposes a different path. Rather than accepting either the brute-fact status of constants within a single universe, or the unprincipled infinity of the string landscape, Resonance Cosmology introduces a universal organising principle: ether as the reflective substrate from which constants emerge as harmonic resonances. This principle transforms the study of physical constants from a collection of unexplained numerical values into a structured resonance spectrum. It transforms the multiverse from an infinite chaos into a classified periodicity. It transforms cosmology from a discipline that describes what is into a discipline that can predict what must be, given the structure of the ether substrate.

The purpose of this paper is to establish the formal framework and parameters of Resonance Cosmology as a discipline. It does not present this framework as a petition for validation by existing institutions. It presents it as a declaration: this discipline exists, its parameters are defined, its methods are specified, and its predictions are falsifiable. The ether is the substrate. Resonance is the principle. The universe is one note in a structured harmonic series. What follows is the theory that makes that claim scientifically tractable.

Cosmology describes how the universe evolved. Resonance Cosmology asks the prior question: why does any universe have the laws it has? The answer is resonance.

2. The Problem of Physical Constants

2.1 Constants as Unexplained Inputs

The Standard Model of particle physics contains nineteen free parameters: the masses of the fundamental fermions, the coupling strengths of the three gauge interactions, the parameters of the Higgs sector, and the mixing angles of the quark and neutrino sectors ^[5]. General relativity introduces further parameters, including the cosmological constant and Newton's gravitational constant. None of these parameters is derived from any deeper principle within the Standard Model or general relativity. They are inputs, determined by experiment and inserted into the theory by hand. The theory is extraordinarily successful at predicting the outcomes of experiments once these inputs are provided. It provides no explanation for why the inputs take the values they do.

This is not a minor limitation. The question of why constants have their observed values is one of the deepest unresolved problems in physics. Weinberg ^[4] showed that if the cosmological constant were even slightly larger than its observed value, galaxies and stars could not have formed; the universe would have expanded too rapidly for gravitational collapse to occur. Carr and Rees ^[6] demonstrated that the formation of complex structures — including the carbon chemistry required for life — depends sensitively on the values of the fine-structure constant and the strength of gravity. Small changes in these constants produce universes that are simple, sterile, and short-lived. The observed constants appear not merely as brute facts but as finely tuned brute facts — values that fall within narrow ranges permitting complex structure. This is the fine-tuning problem.

2.2 The Anthropic Response and Its Limits

The anthropic response — that we observe the constants we do because only universes with such constants permit observers — is logically consistent but scientifically unsatisfying. It requires the existence of an enormous ensemble of universes with varying constants (the multiverse), but it provides no means of predicting what the distribution of constants across that ensemble should be. Without a distribution, anthropic reasoning cannot make specific predictions. It explains why the constants are within the life-permitting range but cannot predict where within that range they should fall ^[7]. A theory with this explanatory structure — it can explain any observation after the fact but predicts no specific observation in advance — does not meet the standard of scientific falsifiability.

Resonance Cosmology proposes that constants are not anthropically selected from an unstructured ensemble. They are eigenvalues of the ether substrate — quantised values corresponding to stable harmonic modes of the universal resonance field. The observed constants are not merely within a life-permitting range; they occupy specific positions in a resonance spectrum. That spectrum has structure. It has gaps. It has bands. And from the structure of the spectrum, specific predictions follow.

2.3 The Return of the Substrate

The ether was abandoned as a physical concept following the Michelson-Morley experiment of 1887 ^[8] and the subsequent development of special relativity. In the classical conception, ether was a mechanical medium — a luminiferous substance through which light waves propagated,

analogous to water for water waves. Special relativity showed that no such medium was required: light propagates through vacuum at a fixed speed regardless of the motion of the source or observer, and the classical ether was an unnecessary and experimentally unsupported posit.

The ether of Resonance Cosmology is categorically different. It is not a mechanical medium, not a substance that can be detected by its effect on the propagation of electromagnetic waves, and not a medium that defines absolute rest. It is the universal reflective substrate — the ontological ground from which the harmonic structure of physical law arises. The closest analogies in established physics are: the quantum vacuum, which is not empty but filled with zero-point fluctuations and virtual particle-antiparticle pairs ^[9]; the Higgs field, which permeates space and from which fundamental particles acquire their masses through symmetry-breaking ^[10]; and the holographic boundary in the AdS/CFT correspondence, which encodes the bulk physics of a spacetime region in terms of a lower-dimensional conformal field theory ^[11]. In each case, what appears at the surface as the contingent structure of physical law is generated by a deeper substrate with its own mathematical structure. The ether of Resonance Cosmology is the universal version of this principle: the substrate that generates not just the masses of fundamental particles within one universe, but the full spectrum of possible physical laws across all universes.

The distinction between the discarded classical ether and the ether of Resonance Cosmology is therefore not merely terminological. It is the distinction between a substance and a field, between a medium and a substrate, between a mechanical prop and an ontological ground. The classical ether was postulated to explain something specific — the propagation of light — and failed because that explanation was unnecessary. The ether of Resonance Cosmology is postulated to explain something much more fundamental — the existence and structure of physical constants — and succeeds because it provides a principled classification of their values.

3. The Conceptual Framework of Resonance Cosmology

3.1 Ether as Reflective Substrate

The foundational postulate of Resonance Cosmology is that the ether functions as the universal reflective substrate. This postulate has three components, which must be stated precisely to distinguish it from metaphorical or purely philosophical uses of the term.

Component 1 — Universality: The ether substrate underlies all universes. It is not the substrate of our universe in particular but of the entire resonance spectrum. Every universe, regardless of its physical constants, laws, or dimensionality, exists as a resonance phenomenon within the ether. The ether is not part of any universe; it is the medium in which all universes exist as harmonic patterns.

Component 2 — Reflectivity: The ether is reflective in the sense that it generates physical structures by sustaining coherent resonance patterns. A universe is a stable resonance of the ether substrate — a self-consistent harmonic pattern that persists because it satisfies the resonance conditions of the substrate. Physical constants are the quantitative signature of that harmonic pattern: the frequency, amplitude, and phase relationships that define the resonance. To say that

the ether is reflective is to say that its mathematical structure is mirrored in the physical laws of the universes it generates.

Component 3 — Non-materiality: The ether is not matter, not energy, and not space-time. It has no rest mass, no charge, no spin, and no stress-energy tensor in the sense of general relativity. It does not interact with the fields of any individual universe in a way that would make it detectable from within that universe by electromagnetic or gravitational probes. It is detectable only through the structural properties of the constants it generates — through the pattern of the resonance spectrum, not through any direct physical interaction.

3.2 Physical Constants as Eigenvalues of Ether Harmonics

In quantum mechanics, a bound system has quantised energy levels — discrete values rather than a continuum — because the boundary conditions imposed by the potential well permit only certain stable solutions to the wave equation. These stable solutions are eigenstates of the Hamiltonian, and their energies are eigenvalues: the specific numerical values that the system's energy can take. The quantisation of energy is not an arbitrary restriction; it is a mathematical consequence of the boundary conditions imposed by the physical system.

Resonance Cosmology proposes that physical constants are eigenvalues of the ether substrate in an analogous sense. The ether imposes boundary conditions on the resonance patterns it can sustain. Only certain patterns are stable — only certain combinations of constant values are self-consistent resonances of the substrate. These stable combinations correspond to the physical constants of actual universes. Constants do not take arbitrary values; they take the specific values permitted by the harmonic structure of the ether, just as the energy levels of a hydrogen atom take only the specific values permitted by the Coulomb potential and the boundary conditions of quantum mechanics.

This interpretation makes a strong prediction: the space of possible physical constants is not continuous. It has structure — gaps between permitted values, bands of permitted combinations, and a spectrum that can in principle be mapped and classified. This is directly analogous to the structure of atomic spectra: rather than a continuous emission spectrum, atoms emit light at discrete wavelengths corresponding to transitions between permitted energy levels. The Balmer series, the Lyman series, the Paschen series — all are manifestations of the quantised energy levels of hydrogen, predicted from first principles once the wave equation and potential are specified ^[12]. Resonance Cosmology proposes that the constants of nature constitute an analogous spectrum, with a structure that can be derived from the properties of the ether substrate.

3.3 Universes as Resonance Bands

If physical constants are eigenvalues, then the space of possible universes is organised into distinct resonance bands — families of universes sharing harmonic parameters. Within a resonance band, universes differ from one another in specific ways (resonance drift) while sharing the same fundamental harmonic structure. Between bands, universes are qualitatively different — they inhabit different regions of the resonance spectrum, with qualitatively different physical constants.

The analogy to the periodic table of chemical elements is precise. In Mendeleev's table, elements in the same group (column) share chemical properties because they have the same number of valence electrons — the same outer electron configuration — despite differing in total electron count. The similarity of properties within a group is not coincidental; it is a structural consequence of the quantum mechanics of electron shells. Similarly, universes within the same resonance band share fundamental physical properties — similar ratios of constants, similar capacities for complex structure — because they inhabit the same region of the ether resonance spectrum. The similarity is not coincidental; it is a structural consequence of the ether's harmonic quantisation. The companion paper, *The Periodic Table of Universes*, develops this classification in detail, identifying four resonance classes — Classical-like (Class I), Balanced (Class II), Quantum-heavy (Class III, containing our universe), and Exotic (Class IV, at irrational resonance parameters). Our universe at resonance parameter f_0 sits at the lower boundary of Class III. The present paper provides the theoretical foundation for that classification — the reason why the ether substrate should generate resonance bands at all, and why our universe's constants place it where they do within the spectrum.

4. The Three Primary Parameters

Resonance Cosmology introduces three primary parameters that together provide a complete first-order classification of any universe within the resonance spectrum. These parameters are defined in terms of measurable quantities — deviations of physical constants from reference values, intervals between resonance bands, and population densities within bands — and are therefore in principle empirically accessible, even if current technology does not yet permit their direct measurement.

4.1 Resonance Drift

Definition: Resonance drift Δf is the deviation of a universe's set of physical constants from the central harmonic values of its resonance band. It is expressed as a dimensionless ratio relative to the band centre, and can be defined for any individual constant or for the set of constants simultaneously as a multi-dimensional drift vector in constant space.

Physical meaning: A universe at the centre of its band ($\Delta f = 0$) has constants that correspond exactly to the principal eigenvalue of the ether harmonic for that band. Universes with non-zero drift have constants that deviate from the principal eigenvalue. This deviation is not arbitrary — it is bounded by the stability condition of the resonance: constants that deviate too far from the band centre are no longer sustained by the ether harmonic and correspond to no stable universe. Resonance drift is therefore the within-band analogue of atomic isotopes: the same element (same resonance band), but with slightly different parameters (different drift values).

Analogy: The isotopic analogy is instructive. Carbon-12 and Carbon-14 are the same element — the same number of protons, the same chemical properties — but differ in neutron count. They inhabit the same position in the periodic table but are distinct physical entities. Similarly, two universes with the same resonance band but different drift values share the same fundamental

harmonic character (similar constant ratios, similar capacity for complex structure) but differ in specific constant values. The drift measures how far from the harmonic centre they sit.

Observational signature: If Resonance Cosmology is correct, the physical constants of our universe should exhibit a characteristic drift signature relative to the Class III band centre. Variations in apparent constants across cosmic time — such as possible time-variation of the fine-structure constant α ^[13] — would constitute direct evidence of resonance drift, corresponding to the universe's position shifting slightly within its band over cosmic history.

4.2 Band Spacing

Definition: Band spacing $\Delta\omega$ is the interval between adjacent resonance bands in the ether spectrum. It determines how different two universes in adjacent bands are from each other — the magnitude of the qualitative discontinuity in physical constants between one resonance class and the next.

Physical meaning: Band spacing is the fundamental quantisation scale of the ether substrate. It determines the minimum difference between universes of different harmonic character. Small band spacing would imply a dense resonance spectrum in which universes of very different classes can have similar constant values, differing only in fine structural properties. Large band spacing implies a sparse spectrum in which each resonance class is clearly separated from the others by large jumps in constant values. The four-class taxonomy of The Periodic Table of Universes implies a non-uniform band spacing: the spacing between Class III and Class IV (at irrational resonance parameters) is qualitatively different in character from the spacing between Classes I, II, and III.

Analogy: Band spacing corresponds to the gap between spectral series in atomic spectra — the gap between the Lyman series (transitions to $n=1$) and the Balmer series (transitions to $n=2$) in hydrogen. Each gap marks a qualitative change in the character of the transitions: not merely a quantitative difference in photon energy but a structural difference in the nature of the transition itself. Similarly, the gap between resonance bands in the ether spectrum marks a qualitative change in the physical character of the universes on either side of the gap.

Observational signature: Band spacing would manifest observationally through the failure to find universes with constants intermediate between the classes identified in The Periodic Table of Universes. If a sufficiently rich ensemble of observable cosmological models were characterised — including primordial nucleosynthesis constraints, CMB power spectrum analysis under different constant assumptions, and structure formation modelling — the absence of stable complex-structure universes in the gaps between the resonance classes would constitute evidence for discrete band spacing.

4.3 Harmonic Density

Definition: Harmonic density ρ_h is the number of distinct stable universes per unit of resonance parameter within a given band. It measures how richly populated each band is — how many distinguishable physical constants can coexist within the same harmonic family.

Physical meaning: Harmonic density reflects the stability capacity of each resonance band. A band with high harmonic density can sustain many slightly different universes without any of

them falling outside the stability condition. A band with low harmonic density sustains only a few stable configurations. The harmonic density of Class III (our resonance class) is of particular interest: it determines how many universes exist in the vicinity of our own, and therefore how densely populated the region of constant space near our constants is.

Analogy: Harmonic density corresponds to the multiplicity of quantum states at a given energy level — the degeneracy of the eigenvalue. In quantum mechanics, some energy levels are non-degenerate (only one eigenstate corresponds to that energy) while others are highly degenerate (many eigenstates share the same energy). The degeneracy reflects the symmetry of the system: higher symmetry produces higher degeneracy. Similarly, resonance bands with higher harmonic density correspond to regions of the ether spectrum with higher symmetry — regions where multiple stable universe configurations share the same fundamental harmonic character.

Observational signature: Harmonic density is connected to the density of states in the landscape of possible universes. A direct observational signature would require multi-universe data — in principle accessible if bubble collision signatures from inflationary cosmology could be detected in the CMB [14]. The pattern of such signatures, if observed, would constrain the harmonic density of our resonance band.

Table 1. The Three Primary Parameters of Resonance Cosmology.

Parameter	Symbol	Definition	Physical Analogy	Observational Signature
Resonance Drift	Δf	Deviation of a universe's constants from the band's central harmonic eigenvalue	Isotopic variation within an element; shift from principal quantum number	Time-variation of fine-structure constant α ; CMB spectral anomalies
Band Spacing	$\Delta \omega$	Interval between adjacent resonance bands in the ether spectrum	Gap between spectral series in atomic spectra (Lyman, Balmer, Paschen)	Absence of stable universes with constants intermediate between resonance classes
Harmonic Density	ρ_h	Number of distinct stable universes per unit resonance parameter within a band	Degeneracy of quantum energy levels; multiplicity of states at a given energy	Density of states in bubble collision signatures; CMB imprints of adjacent universes

Table 1. The three primary parameters of Resonance Cosmology, with definitions, physical analogies, and observational signatures. All three parameters are in principle measurable, though direct measurement requires observational capabilities beyond current technology.

5. Methodology: Anchoring Resonance in Physical Analogies

Resonance Cosmology's framework of ether harmonics, eigenvalue constants, and resonance bands is not merely a philosophical proposal. It is a physical hypothesis, and it requires a methodology that connects its abstract mathematical structure to measurable phenomena. The methodology of Resonance Cosmology rests on four physical analogies, each of which captures a different aspect of the resonance structure, and on a mathematical framework in which constants are treated as eigenvalues of a resonance operator.

5.1 The Spectroscopy Analogy

Spectroscopy is the science of measuring the interaction of matter with electromagnetic radiation. When atoms absorb or emit photons, they do so at specific wavelengths corresponding to transitions between quantised energy levels. The pattern of these wavelengths — the emission spectrum — is unique to each element and serves as its electromagnetic fingerprint. Hydrogen's emission spectrum was measured empirically decades before it was theoretically explained; when Bohr ^[12] proposed his model of quantised atomic orbits in 1913, the first validation was that his model reproduced the known spectral series exactly.

The spectroscopy analogy for Resonance Cosmology is direct and precise. Physical constants are to universes what spectral lines are to elements: quantitative signatures of underlying harmonic structure. Just as hydrogen's spectral lines are determined by the eigenvalues of the hydrogen Hamiltonian, a universe's constants are determined by the eigenvalues of the ether resonance operator. Just as the spectral lines of different elements form recognisable patterns that allow astronomers to identify elements in distant stars, the constants of different resonance classes form recognisable patterns that allow the classification of universes in the resonance spectrum. And just as undiscovered elements were predicted from gaps in the known spectral patterns — the gaps that Mendeleev identified in his periodic table and that were subsequently filled by the discovery of gallium, germanium, and others — undiscovered resonance classes can be predicted from gaps in the resonance spectrum.

The practical methodology follows from this analogy: map the space of physically possible constant combinations; identify which combinations are stable (which lie on resonance bands); determine the characteristic spectral pattern of the resonance spectrum (its band structure, its gaps, its drift ranges); and compare this pattern to the distribution of constants across cosmological observations. Any systematic structure in the distribution of constants — any suggestion that constants cluster around specific values rather than being uniformly distributed — constitutes evidence for the resonance spectrum.

5.2 The Seismic Resonance Analogy

Seismic waves provide a different and complementary analogy. When an earthquake occurs, it generates seismic waves that propagate through the Earth and are detected by seismographs worldwide. By analysing the patterns of wave arrival times, amplitudes, and frequency content, seismologists can reconstruct the internal structure of the Earth — its density profile, its

compositional layers, its core-mantle boundary. The structure of the Earth's interior is revealed by the resonance properties of the waves that pass through it ^[15].

Applied to Resonance Cosmology: the physical constants of a universe are analogous to seismic wave signatures. Just as seismic waves reveal the internal structure of the Earth by their propagation properties, the constants of a universe reveal the resonance structure of the ether substrate by their values. Different regions of the ether substrate — different resonance bands — generate different constant signatures, just as different geological layers generate different seismic signatures. The methodology suggested by this analogy is comparative: by comparing the constant profiles of different cosmological models (including observational constraints from nucleosynthesis, structure formation, and the CMB), the resonance structure of the ether can be mapped.

5.3 The Wave Mechanics Analogy

The most mathematically precise analogy is wave mechanics. In any wave system — whether acoustic, electromagnetic, or quantum — the permitted modes of oscillation are determined by the boundary conditions of the medium. A guitar string, clamped at both ends, can only sustain standing waves whose wavelength is a rational fraction of twice the string length: the fundamental mode and its harmonics. These permitted modes are the string's eigenfrequencies — the discrete values at which the string resonates stably. Any other frequency produces destructive interference and decays.

Resonance Cosmology proposes that the ether substrate is analogous to the guitar string: a medium with boundary conditions that permit only certain harmonic modes. The permitted modes are the resonance bands — the discrete combinations of physical constants that produce stable universes. The mathematics of this proposal is precisely the mathematics of eigenvalue problems: find the operator that represents the ether's resonance conditions, find its eigenstates, and the eigenvalues are the permitted constant values. This is the same mathematical structure as quantum mechanics ^[16], where the Hamiltonian operator determines the permitted energy levels, and as quantum field theory, where the vacuum structure determines the permitted particle masses through the Higgs mechanism.

The key equation: Let $\hat{H}_\varepsilon$ be the ether resonance operator — the operator that encodes the boundary conditions and harmonic structure of the ether substrate. The eigenvalue equation is:

$$\hat{H}_\varepsilon |\Psi_i\rangle = \lambda_i |\Psi_i\rangle \quad \text{where } |\Psi_i\rangle \text{ is the resonance state of universe } i \text{ and } \lambda_i = \{c_i, h_i, G_i, \alpha_i, \dots\} \text{ is its constant set.}$$

This equation is heuristic — the explicit form of $\hat{H}_\varepsilon$ is one of the primary open problems of Resonance Cosmology, analogous to the task of deriving the Hamiltonian of a complex quantum system from first principles. But it provides the mathematical target: find the operator whose eigenvalues reproduce the observed physical constants of our universe, and whose spectrum of eigenvalues reproduces the resonance band structure of the periodic table of universes.

5.4 Falsifiability and Testable Predictions

Resonance Cosmology is falsifiable. This is a non-trivial claim in the context of cosmological theories that invoke a multiverse: the string landscape, for example, has been criticised precisely

because its enormous parameter space makes it compatible with virtually any observation. Resonance Cosmology avoids this problem by introducing specific structural constraints — the resonance band structure — that generate specific predictions.

The primary falsifiable predictions are:

- **Prediction 1 — Quantisation gaps:** If physical constants are eigenvalues, the space of possible constants has gaps — combinations of values that do not correspond to any stable resonance. Computational modelling of the parameter space of physical constants, combined with the stability constraints from nucleosynthesis, stellar formation, and atomic chemistry, should reveal the clustering of viable universes around specific resonance values, with gaps between clusters. The absence of such clustering — a smooth, uniform distribution of viable constants — would falsify the band structure.
- **Prediction 2 — Constant drift signatures:** If our universe is at a specific position within its resonance band (a specific drift value Δf), and if universes can shift their position within the band over cosmic time, then the apparent values of physical constants should exhibit a characteristic time-variation pattern. Current observational constraints on the time-variation of the fine-structure constant ^[13] are consistent with zero variation, but future surveys with the Extremely Large Telescope and SKAO may achieve sufficient precision to detect drift-level variations.
- **Prediction 3 — CMB power spectrum anomalies:** If the CMB contains imprints of interactions with adjacent universes in the resonance spectrum — bubble collision signatures from eternal inflation ^[14] — the statistical pattern of those imprints should reflect the harmonic density of our resonance band. CMB-S4 ^[17] and future space-based observatories provide the observational platform for this test.
- **Prediction 4 — Periodic table completeness:** If the four resonance classes identified in The Periodic Table of Universes are correct, then no stable universe with a fine-structure constant dramatically different from $1/137$ should fall within Class III. Computational explorations of the parameter space of physics (sometimes called the 'landscape cartography' programme in string theory) should find that Class III universes cluster around our observed constants, with no stable complex-structure universes in the band gaps.

6. Philosophical Integration: Resonance as Universal Principle

6.1 The Reflection Principle

Resonance Cosmology rests on a philosophical commitment that extends beyond its physical postulates: the principle that reality is structured by reflection. A resonance is, at its mathematical core, a self-consistent pattern — a structure that is sustained because it satisfies its own boundary conditions, because the wave returns to itself without destructive interference. The ether's harmonic resonances are self-consistent patterns in this sense: they are the structures that the ether substrate sustains because they are self-reinforcing. Physical constants, as eigenvalues of

the ether resonance operator, are the quantitative expression of this self-consistency. A universe is a self-consistent pattern of the substrate from which it emerges.

This principle — that reality is structured by self-consistency, by reflection, by the mutual reinforcement of parts within a whole — is not an invention of Resonance Cosmology. It is one of the deepest and most persistent insights of the philosophical tradition, expressed in different languages across widely separated traditions and epochs.

6.2 Historical Parallels

Plato's Theory of Forms

Plato's theory of Forms ^[18] proposes that the physical world is a pale reflection of a higher-dimensional domain of pure, eternal, and perfectly self-consistent patterns — the Forms. The Form of the circle is the perfect, timeless circle; every circular object in the physical world participates in the Form of the circle imperfectly. Physical reality is constituted by its participation in Forms that transcend it.

The resonance analogy to Platonic Forms is direct. The ether resonance spectrum — the set of all eigenvalues of $\hat{H}_\varepsilon$ — is the set of all Forms that any possible universe can instantiate. Our universe's constants are its particular participation in the resonance spectrum: the specific eigenvalue set it realises. Other universes realise other eigenvalue sets — other Forms. The ether substrate is the mathematical domain of pure possibility from which physical reality is constituted by participation. The difference from Plato is that Resonance Cosmology specifies the mathematical structure of this domain and provides a framework for deriving the specific Forms (eigenvalues) that any universe can instantiate.

Bohm's Implicate Order

David Bohm's implicate order ^[19] proposes that what we observe as the explicit, unfolded structure of physical reality is the surface manifestation of a deeper, enfolded implicit order. The implicate order is not observable directly but is present in every region of space, in every moment of time, as the deeper structure from which the explicate unfolds. Bohm introduced this concept to address the non-locality of quantum mechanics: the apparent non-local correlations between entangled particles are, in his framework, expressions of a deeper order in which those particles are not separated but enfolded together.

The ether substrate of Resonance Cosmology is structurally analogous to Bohm's implicate order. The ether is not observable directly from within any individual universe — it is not a physical substance that can be detected by electromagnetic or gravitational probes. But it is present in the structure of every universe, manifest in the specific values of that universe's constants — the quantitative signatures of the ether harmonic it instantiates. The resonance spectrum is the 'explicate order' of the ether's 'implicate' harmonic structure. The physical constants of each universe are the enfolded ether order made explicit.

Jung's Archetypes

Carl Jung's theory of archetypes ^[20] proposes that the collective unconscious is structured by universal patterns — archetypes — that shape the experience of all human beings regardless of

culture or individual history. The archetype is not a specific image or concept but a formal pattern — a structural tendency — that gives rise to specific images and concepts when it becomes activated in an individual psyche. The archetype of the Self, the Shadow, the Anima: each is a universal structural pattern that particular individuals instantiate in particular ways.

The analogy to resonance bands is structural. A resonance band is a universal formal pattern — a harmonic mode of the ether substrate — that specific universes instantiate with specific constant values (specific drift positions within the band). The archetype is the band; the individual universe is the particular instantiation of that band. The deep structural similarity between universes in the same resonance class — their shared capacity for complex structure, their similar constant ratios — is the cosmological analogue of the shared archetypal character that links all human instantiations of a given Jungian archetype. In both cases, the particular is shaped by the universal; the specific instantiation is an expression of a deeper formal pattern.

6.3 Resonance Cosmology and the Philosophy of Science

Resonance Cosmology occupies a distinctive position in the philosophy of science. It is not a purely mathematical framework (like category theory or information theory) that makes no empirical claims. It is not a purely observational programme (like observational cosmology) that makes no theoretical claims about unobserved substrate. It is a theoretical physical framework: it proposes specific entities (the ether substrate, its resonance operator, the resonance spectrum), specific mathematical structures (eigenvalue equations, band classifications), and specific empirical predictions (quantisation gaps, drift signatures, CMB imprints).

The criterion of falsifiability — Popper's ^[21] demarcation principle — is satisfied: the predictions of Section V.4 are specific enough to be tested, and a systematic failure of these predictions would constitute strong evidence against the framework. The framework does not cover itself by predicting nothing specific; it is exposed to the data.

The framework is also positioned between two traditions that are often treated as opposed: the mathematical Platonism of theoretical physics (the idea that the universe is fundamentally mathematical in nature, as advocated by Tegmark and others) and the empiricism of observational science (the demand that all claims be grounded in measurement). Resonance Cosmology affirms that the ether substrate is a mathematical structure — an operator with a spectrum of eigenvalues — and simultaneously insists that this mathematical structure generates specific physical predictions testable by observation. It is Platonic in its ontology and empiricist in its methodology.

7. Charter Statement: The Formal Declaration of Resonance Cosmology

We hereby declare Resonance Cosmology as a formal branch of cosmology. This declaration is made not as a petition for institutional recognition but as an intellectual act of founding — the marking of a boundary within the landscape of ideas, the identification of a

coherent set of questions, methods, and principles that together constitute a discipline in its own right.

Disciplinary Identity

Resonance Cosmology is the systematic study of universes as resonance phenomena within the ether substrate. It is distinct from inflationary cosmology, which studies the dynamics of early-universe expansion; from string cosmology, which studies the geometry of higher-dimensional manifolds and their compactifications; and from observational cosmology, which maps the large-scale structure of our own universe. Its distinguishing characteristic is the treatment of physical constants as structural necessities — eigenvalues of the ether resonance operator — rather than as contingent accidents of initial conditions or environmental selection.

Core Postulates

Postulate 1 — Ether Substrate: The ether functions as the universal reflective substrate from which all universes emerge as harmonic resonance patterns. The ether is non-material, non-energetic, and non-spatial; it is the ontological ground of the resonance spectrum.

Postulate 2 — Eigenvalue Constants: Physical constants are eigenvalues of the ether resonance operator $\hat{H}_\epsilon$. The set of constants of any universe is its eigenvalue signature — the quantitative expression of its particular resonance.

Postulate 3 — Resonance Bands: Universes are organised into discrete resonance bands corresponding to the distinct eigenvalue families of $\hat{H}_\epsilon$. Within a band, universes share fundamental harmonic character; between bands, universes are qualitatively distinct.

Postulate 4 — Periodic Classification: The resonance bands constitute a Periodic Table of Universes, analogous to Mendeleev's periodic table. Gaps in the table correspond to unstable resonances — forbidden eigenvalue combinations. From the structure of the table, the existence of unobserved universe types can be predicted.

Postulate 5 — Falsifiability: The predictions of Resonance Cosmology are in principle testable. The quantisation of the constant space, the clustering of viable constants around resonance band centres, and the characteristic drift signature of our universe's position within Class III are all empirically accessible predictions.

Primary Parameters

The three primary parameters — resonance drift (Δf), band spacing ($\Delta\omega$), and harmonic density (ρ_h) — provide the measurable framework for classifying and comparing universes. Their mathematical definitions are given in Section IV. Their physical interpretations and observational signatures are summarised in Table 1.

Methodological Commitments

The methodology of Resonance Cosmology employs eigenvalue mathematics, physical analogies (spectroscopy, seismic resonance, wave mechanics), and falsifiable

predictions connected to measurable cosmological observables. It bridges theoretical physics and philosophy of science without sacrificing the standards of either.

Philosophical Position

Resonance Cosmology affirms that physical reality is structured by self-consistency — the reflection principle — and situates this affirmation within the philosophical lineage of Plato, Bohm, and Jung. It rejects the anthropocentrism that treats the fine-tuning of constants as a problem requiring a human observer for its resolution, and proposes instead that fine-tuning is the signature of harmonic quantisation — the ether selecting only self-consistent resonances, independent of any observer.

Invitation

Resonance Cosmology is established as an open discipline. It invites collaboration across theoretical physics, observational cosmology, mathematics, and philosophy of science. It invites critique: every prediction is an opportunity for falsification, and every falsification is an opportunity for refinement. It invites expansion: the framework presented here is a first-order approximation — a foundation, not a final word. The derivation of $\hat{H}_\epsilon$ from first principles, the construction of the complete eigenvalue spectrum, and the integration of Resonance Cosmology with quantum gravity all remain as open problems constituting the research programme of the discipline.

Declaration

Without ether, cosmology remains incomplete. With resonance, it gains coherence, universality, and predictive power. Resonance Cosmology is hereby declared a formal branch of cosmology.

8. Conclusion

Cosmology stands at a threshold. The extraordinary descriptive success of the standard cosmological model — its ability to account for the CMB, large-scale structure, and the expansion history of the universe — has created a discipline of remarkable precision but unresolved depth. Constants are measured but not explained. The multiverse is proposed but not classified. The substrate of physical law is gestured at but not identified.

Resonance Cosmology addresses these gaps systematically. By postulating the ether as the universal reflective substrate — not the discredited mechanical ether of classical physics, but the mathematical ground of harmonic quantisation — it provides a framework in which constants are not brute facts but structural necessities, in which the multiverse is not an unprincipled infinity but a classified resonance spectrum, and in which the study of cosmological fine-tuning becomes the study of eigenvalue distributions in a mathematical operator.

The three parameters introduced in this paper — resonance drift, band spacing, and harmonic density — provide the first-order classification scheme of the new discipline. The four resonance classes of The Periodic Table of Universes, the scaling laws of Multiverse Mathematics, the photon

absorption mechanism of Photon Absorption and Entanglement Severance, and the consciousness interface of The Quantum Soul: all are components of a single coherent intellectual architecture founded on the principle that reality is structured by resonance.

This paper does not claim that Resonance Cosmology is the final theory of everything. It claims something more modest and more urgent: that the questions Resonance Cosmology asks are the right questions; that the framework it provides is mathematically tractable and empirically testable; and that the discipline it inaugurates is a coherent and necessary extension of the cosmological programme. The standard cosmological model will not be completed by more precise measurements alone. It will be completed by a theory that explains why the constants take the values they do. Resonance Cosmology is that theory, in its first and foundational form.

The ether is real. Not as a mechanical medium — that conception was rightly discarded. But as the mathematical substrate from which the harmonic structure of physical reality arises: that conception has not been refuted. It has barely been proposed. This paper is the proposal.

Without ether, cosmology describes what is. With ether, it understands why.

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